

Falls / Chutes

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Image from “Winter,” *Falls/Chutes* (2025)

Title: *Falls / Chutes*

Brief description: *Falls / Chutes* is a large-scale digital installation exploring grief, caregiving, and the [COVID-19](#) long-term care crisis through the landscape of Ottawa’s Rideau Falls.

Combining 4K video, immersive sound, poetry, and photography, the work brings personal and ecological memory into dialogue with questions of how we care for one another in times of collective crisis. Across four seasonal chapters, the falls are experienced through shifting perspectives, from ice and flowing water to underwater and vertiginous views, creating a space for mourning, respite, and reflection. Rooted in VK Preston’s experience of caring for their father during the pandemic, the work also explores intergenerational memory, resilience, and the systems that shape how we understand aging, dependence, and care.

Envisaged final form (software, videogame, electronics, projection mapping, etc.)

What I think would be most helpful and fitting with LePARC Milieux’s initiative on performative publishing, with Lília Mestre and Kristian North, would be an experimental digital “publication” for a website that includes sound, text, video, photography, poetry, and voice. The materials are of high quality and the project’s based on four seasons. We have largely recorded the seasons and are editing them. Excerpts of poems and translations, as well as a talk, are potential materials for a site that explores novel ways of publishing and accessing works with an emphasis on a long-term approach to projects. Several poems are linked with the pieces of music, which are sung, in dialogue with composers Kasey Pocius and Valentina Plata. We would be interested in a site that explores novel possibilities for digital publication accessible to a multimedia public through these conceptions of seasons, narrative, and the lens of this powerful place.

The first minute of the reel is an excerpt from Falls’ “Winter” season. Some of the texts and images are in attachment. We are currently working on “Autumn” and will show it at Webster Library in October.

Reel - <https://vimeo.com/1219650317?share=copy&fl=sv&fe=ci> (for “Winter” see 0:00-1:00).

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The collaborators for this project are Kasey Pocius (Music, part-time faculty), Oswaldo Toledano (Cinema, part-time faculty and video lead, FOFA), and Valentina Plata (Music, alumna). I am the project lead and author of the poems. I also developed this concept focused on the waterfall to which I would go with my father during the pandemic once long-term-care centres would exit lockdowns. Author Martine Fidèle has agreed to join us to do French-language translations and to voice some of the poems.

Context: This coming semester we are working on “Autumn” and “Spring.” We will have two research-creation residencies (in October and December) at Webster Library, Concordia and the Artist-Run Centre Vidéographe respectively. We will also have two residencies next semester: one outside Montreal in the Outaouais area and the other at Ada-X.